Financial Audit FY2026 - Executive Summary

Prepared for the CFO, 29 October 2026. Covers 05 Jan 2026 - 31 Dec 2026.

Overall position

The company spent $4,391,000 in the period against a combined budget of $7,728,000, or 57% of budget, leaving $3,337,000 unspent. 9 of 10 departments finished within budget. 1 department (Marketing) exceeded budget by more than 10%.

Marketing is over budget

Marketing spent $866,000 against a budget of $660,000, $206,000 (31.2%) over. It was over budget in 9 of 12 months, every month from April onward, and the gap widens through the year, reaching $66,000 over in December alone. Counting only months to date, the overspend is $83,000. The monthly budget of $55,000 no longer reflects how the team is spending.

The marketing spend is earning a return

Marketing spend produced $4,610,000 of attributed revenue, 5.32 dollars back for every dollar spent. Returns vary widely by channel: Mailchimp returned 9.7x and LinkedIn Ads 9.0x, while TikTok Ads returned 3.5x, the lowest of any channel. The best and worst campaigns were Email Black Friday (11.0x) and TikTok Back to School (3.1x). Shifting spend from the lowest-return channels is the most direct way to bring Marketing back toward budget, though returns from a channel may fall as more is spent on it.

Largest transactions

All of the five largest transactions are Engineering payments to Azure, ranging from $68,000 to $85,000 and rising month on month. Azure accounts for $781,000 in total, 66% of Engineering spend. Engineering remains within budget, but this cost is growing and should be watched.

Limits of this audit

48 transactions are dated after 29 October 2026 and are included in the full-year figures; it is not yet confirmed whether these are booked commitments or forecasts. Sales, Customer Success, Product used less than 35% of their budgets. That may mean spend is missing from this ledger rather than genuine savings. Capital spending limits were not tested, because the ledger does not separate capital from operating costs.

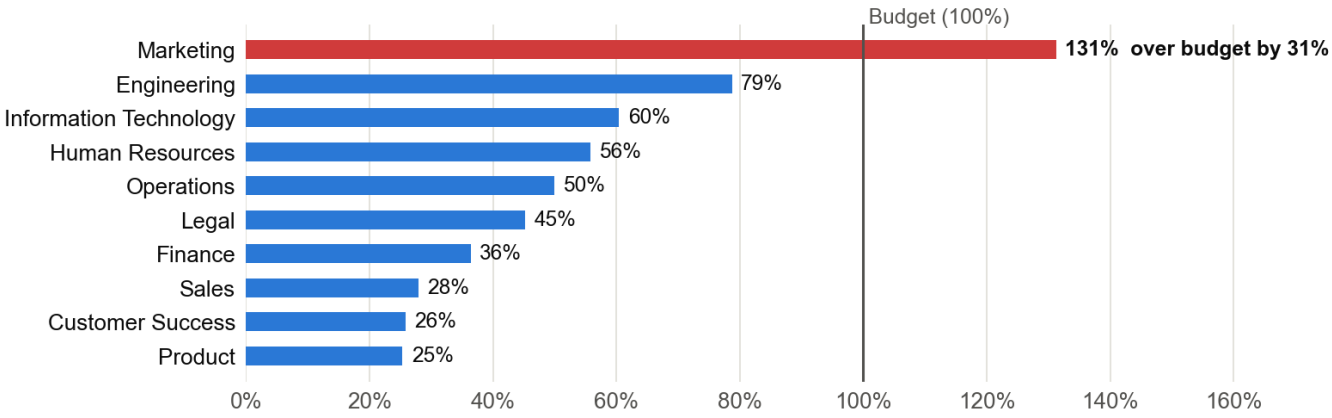
Decisions needed

1. Reset the Marketing budget to match planned spend, or cap spend at the current budget.
2. Confirm the status of the future-dated transactions.
3. Confirm that the ledger is complete for the departments with unusually low spend.

Budget vs Actual by Department

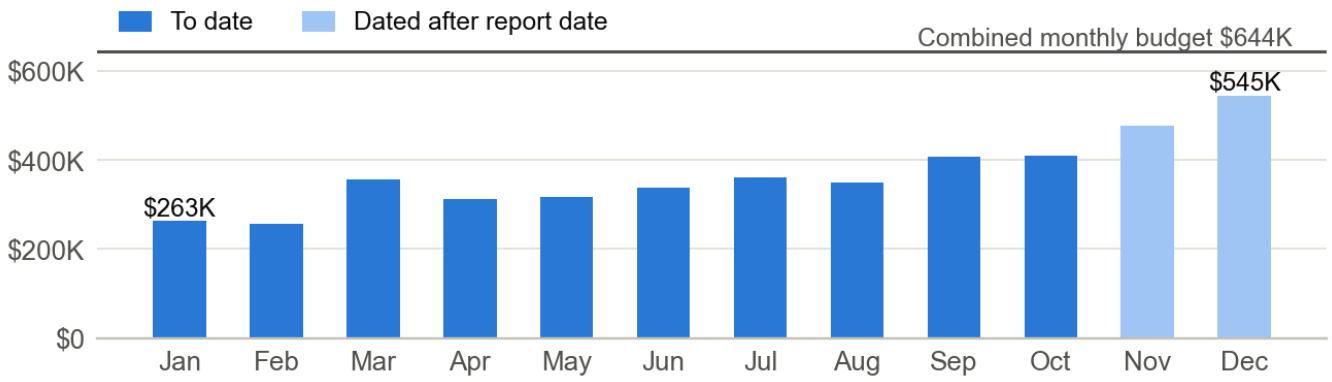
Budget vs actual spend, 05 Jan 2026 - 31 Dec 2026. 263 transactions across 10 departments.

Spend as a share of budget



Red = more than 10% over budget. Only Marketing crosses the line.

Company spend by month



Spend rose from $263K in January to $545K in December, but stayed under the combined monthly budget. Lighter columns are dated after the report date.

Budget vs actual by department

Department	Budget	Actual	Over / (under)	vs budget	Months over	Status
Marketing	**$660,000**	**$866,000**	**+$206,000**	**+31.2%**	**9 / 12**	**OVER >10%**
Engineering	$1,500,000	$1,180,500	-$319,500	-21.3%	1 / 12	Within
Information Technology	$1,140,000	$688,900	-$451,100	-39.6%	0 / 12	Within
Human Resources	$504,000	$281,200	-$222,800	-44.2%	0 / 12	Within
Operations	$1,020,000	$509,200	-$510,800	-50.1%	0 / 12	Within
Legal	$336,000	$151,900	-$184,100	-54.8%	0 / 12	Within
Finance	$372,000	$135,300	-$236,700	-63.6%	0 / 12	Within
Sales	$756,000	$211,000	-$545,000	-72.1%	0 / 12	Within
Customer Success	$576,000	$148,500	-$427,500	-74.2%	0 / 12	Within
Product	$864,000	$218,500	-$645,500	-74.7%	0 / 12	Within

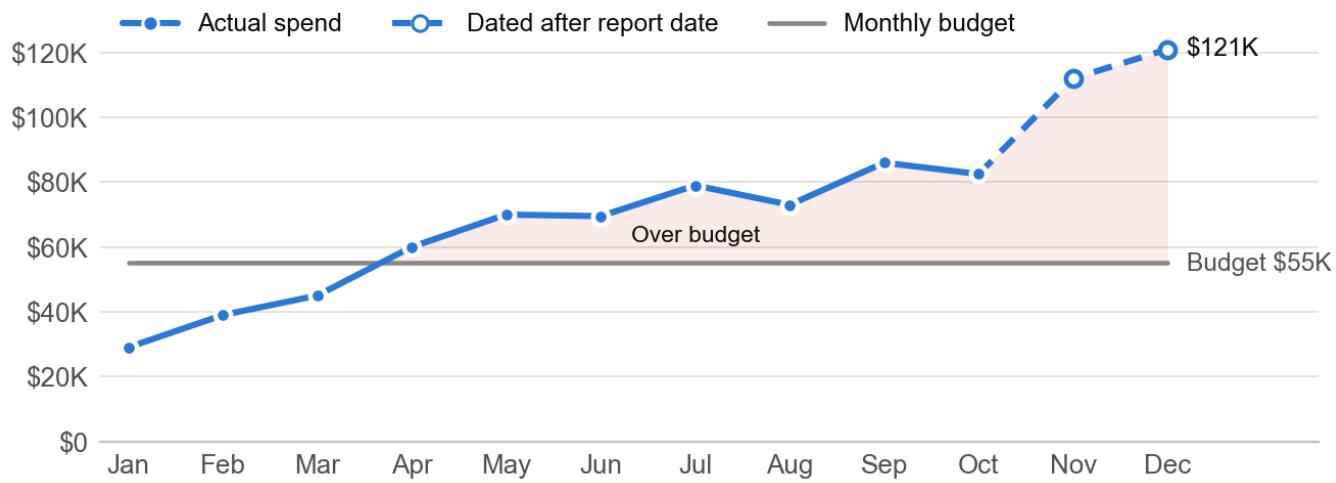
Red = actual spend more than 10% above budget. Positive figures are overspend.

Marketing Performance

36 campaigns, 69 spend flights, 05 Jan 2026 - 31 Dec 2026.

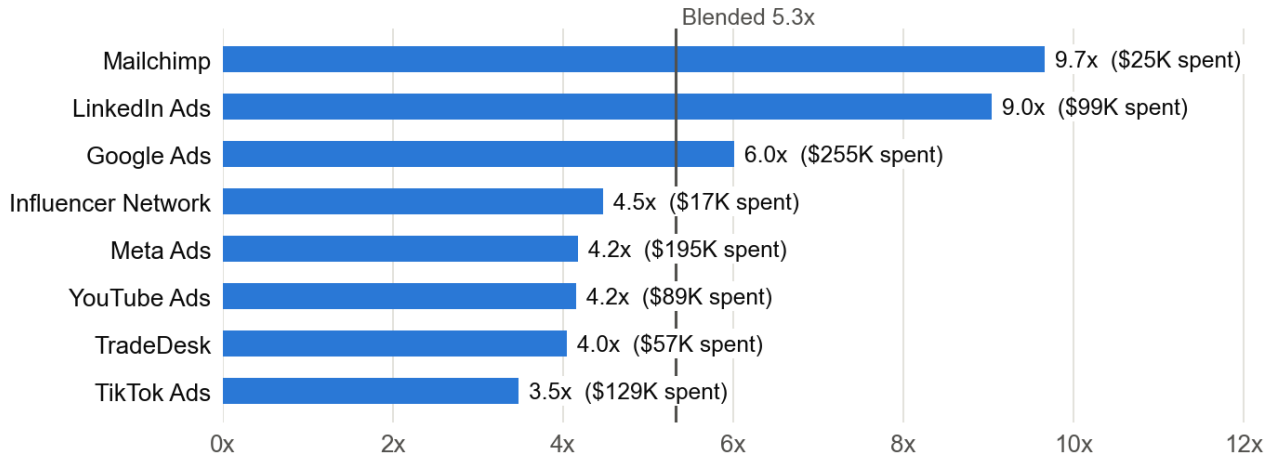
Ad spend	Over budget by	Attributed revenue	Blended ROAS
$866K	**$206K**	**$4.61M**	**5.32x**
Budget $660K	+31.2% vs budget	From marketing_roas.csv	Revenue / ad spend

Marketing spend vs budget, by month



Over budget every month from April; the shaded area is the overspend.

Return on ad spend by channel



Mailchimp and LinkedIn Ads return the most per dollar; TikTok Ads the least.

Campaign Detail

All 36 campaigns, sorted by ROAS.

Campaign	Channel	Flights	Ad spend	Revenue	ROAS
Email Black Friday	Mailchimp	1	$5,000	$55,000	11.00x
Email Holiday Series	Mailchimp	1	$6,000	$65,000	10.83x
LinkedIn B2B Q4	LinkedIn Ads	3	$30,000	$292,000	9.73x
Email Summer Series	Mailchimp	1	$3,000	$28,000	9.33x
Email Fall Promo	Mailchimp	1	$3,500	$32,000	9.14x
LinkedIn B2B Q3	LinkedIn Ads	3	$27,000	$244,000	9.04x
LinkedIn B2B Q2	LinkedIn Ads	4	$30,000	$262,000	8.73x
Email Re-engagement	Mailchimp	3	$7,500	$61,500	8.20x
LinkedIn B2B Q1	LinkedIn Ads	2	$12,000	$97,000	8.08x
Google Search Q4	Google Ads	3	$83,000	$505,000	6.08x
Google Search Q2	Google Ads	4	$76,000	$457,000	6.01x
Google Search Q3	Google Ads	3	$66,000	$393,000	5.95x
Google Search Q1	Google Ads	2	$30,000	$178,500	5.95x
Meta Black Friday	Meta Ads	1	$25,000	$115,000	4.60x
YouTube Holiday	YouTube Ads	1	$15,000	$68,000	4.53x
YouTube Christmas	YouTube Ads	1	$16,000	$72,000	4.50x
Influencer Partnerships	Influencer Network	2	$17,000	$76,000	4.47x
Meta Holiday Campaign	Meta Ads	1	$28,000	$125,000	4.46x
YouTube Fall Preview	YouTube Ads	1	$13,000	$55,000	4.23x
Meta Summer Campaign	Meta Ads	2	$32,000	$133,000	4.16x
Meta Summer Preview	Meta Ads	1	$14,000	$58,000	4.14x
Meta Fall Campaign	Meta Ads	1	$18,000	$74,000	4.11x
Meta Holiday Preview	Meta Ads	1	$20,000	$82,000	4.10x
Programmatic Display	TradeDesk	8	$57,000	$230,500	4.04x
TikTok Holiday Campaign	TikTok Ads	1	$22,000	$88,000	4.00x
Meta Back to School	Meta Ads	1	$18,000	$72,000	4.00x
YouTube Mid-Year	YouTube Ads	1	$13,000	$52,000	4.00x
Meta Spring Campaign	Meta Ads	2	$24,000	$95,000	3.96x
TikTok Black Friday	TikTok Ads	1	$20,000	$78,000	3.90x
YouTube Pre-Roll	YouTube Ads	3	$32,000	$123,000	3.84x
Meta Brand Awareness	Meta Ads	2	$16,000	$61,000	3.81x
TikTok Holiday Teaser	TikTok Ads	1	$16,000	$54,000	3.38x
TikTok Summer Push	TikTok Ads	2	$24,000	$78,000	3.25x
TikTok Awareness	TikTok Ads	2	$18,000	$58,500	3.25x
TikTok Fall Launch	TikTok Ads	1	$15,000	$48,000	3.20x
TikTok Back to School	TikTok Ads	1	$14,000	$44,000	3.14x

ROAS = attributed revenue / ad spend. Attribution is as reported in the marketing data and has not been independently verified.

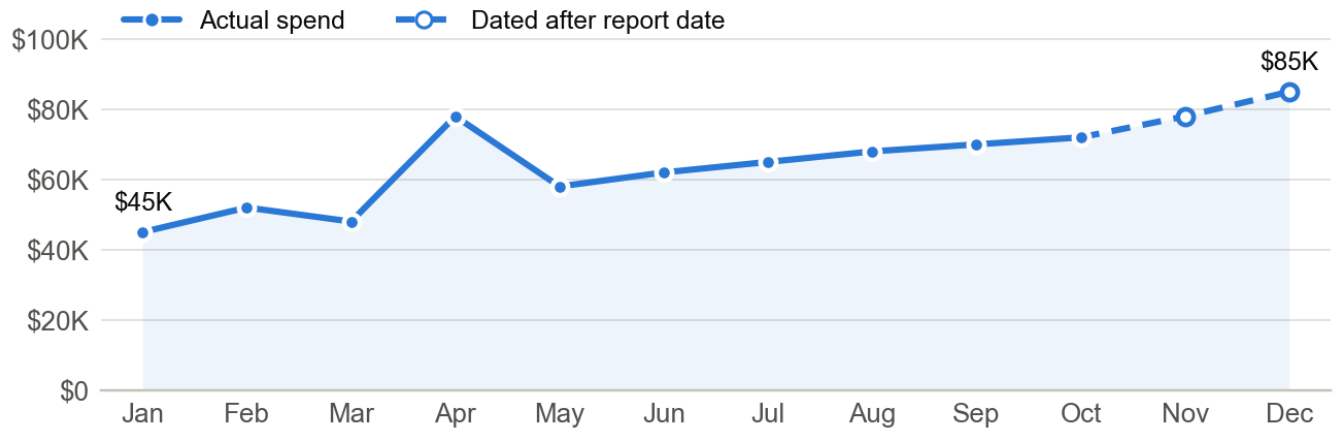
Largest Transactions

Top 5 by amount across all departments.

#	Transaction	Date	Department	Vendor	Amount
1	TXN-254	2026-12-17 *	Engineering	Azure	$85,000
2	TXN-229	2026-11-18 *	Engineering	Azure	$78,000
3	TXN-209	2026-10-21	Engineering	Azure	$72,000
4	TXN-186	2026-09-21	Engineering	Azure	$70,000
5	TXN-163	2026-08-19	Engineering	Azure	$68,000

*These 5 transactions total $373,000, 8.5% of all spend. * Dated after the report date.*

Azure spend by month



Azure cost rose from $45K to $85K a month, 89% over the year.

Method

- Sources: ledger_2026.csv (transactions), budget_targets.csv (monthly budget per department), marketing_roas.csv (campaign revenue), combined by build_master_dataset.py.
- Annual budget = monthly budget x 12. Variance = actual - budget; positive is overspend.
- Marketing campaigns matched to Marketing ledger rows on date and amount; 69 of 69 matched one-to-one. Spend and revenue totals reconcile to source.
- CapEx limits are not assessed: the ledger does not separate capital from operating spend.